MAREN

CONFIDENTIAL

Maren Finance
Technical Feasibility & Architecture

What Mezo gives us, what we must build, and the specific places where the chain does not behave the way its documentation says it does.

DOCUMENT	DATE	VERSION	PREPARED FOR
MRN-DOC-002	15 August 2026	1.0	Mezo Ecosystem

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1

What this document establishes

The investment thesis (MRN-DOC-001) argues that Mezo's constraint is distribution and that Maren removes it. This document establishes that Maren can actually be built, by naming every contract it must call, every place the chain diverges from what a competent engineer would assume, and every failure mode we have to design around.

Three claims are load-bearing:

1. **The MUSD integration surface is complete and reachable.** Every call Maren needs exists on a deployed, verified proxy, and we can compute the hints those calls require. Section 4 gives the exact sequences.
2. **The obvious gasless path is a trap on this chain, and the alternative is better.** ERC-4337 is deployed on Mezo and structurally unusable. Section 8 explains precisely why, and why the path we take instead — EIP-2612 permit plus our own ERC-2771 forwarder, alongside Mezo's own x402 rail — is both simpler and already proven in production by Mezo itself.
3. **The parts that will hurt are known and named.** A pooled trove, one hot key, an oracle that reverts on staleness, one endorsed indexer, and a very short list of RPC endpoints that actually work. Sections 9 and 11 do not soften any of it.

> NOTE
>
> This document is written from verified deployed behaviour rather than from documentation — including our own. That discipline is not stylistic. Section 6 lists three places where Mezo's docs promise something the bytecode does not do; had we built from the docs, we would have shipped a user-visible lie in each case.

2

What Mezo gives us, and what we must build

The single most important fact about this project is how much of it is already done by somebody else. Maren is an application layer, not a protocol.

CAPABILITY	MEZO PROVIDES	MAREN MUST BUILD
BTC-collateralised borrowing	The entire CDP: `BorrowerOperations`, `TroveManager`, liquidation engine, Stability Pool	Nothing. We call it.
Stablecoin	MUSD, with EIP-2612 `permit` and permit2 support	Nothing.
BTC/USD price	Consensus-level oracle exposed as a chain precompile	Staleness handling and an explicit unavailable state
Signed borrower operations	`BorrowerOperationsSignatures`, EIP-712 for every borrower action	Nothing, for direct troves. We call it rather than wrap it.
Gasless payment settlement	x402 settlement proxy, live on both networks	Interoperation, not replacement
Batched reads	Multicall3 at the canonical address on both networks	A corrected chain definition, because viem's omits it
Sub-minimum borrowing	—	`MarenVault`: a pooled trove with per-user accounting
Meta-transactions for our own contracts	—	`MarenForwarder` + relayer
Human-readable payment identity	—	`MarenRegistry`
Consumer payments surface	—	`MarenPay`
Stability Pool yield, tokenised	—	`MarenEarn`, an ERC-4626 wrapper
Indexing	Goldsky support, but no public subgraph	Our own subgraph

Five contracts and one relayer. Everything financial that could be delegated to audited, already-deployed Mezo code is delegated to it.

3

Verified chain facts

Everything in this section was confirmed against live RPCs on 2026-08-15. It is reproduced here because the published sources disagree with reality often enough that a table of what is actually true has real value.

FACT	MAINNET	MATSNET
Chain ID	31612	31611
Chain ID, hex	0x7b7c	0x7b7b
Gas token	BTC	BTC
Decimals	18	18
Primary RPC	`https://jsonrpc-mezo.boar.network`	`https://rpc.test.mezo.org`
Fallback RPC	`https://mainnet.mezo.public.validationcloud.io`	—
Explorer	`https://explorer.mezo.org`	`https://explorer.test.mezo.org`
Explorer API	`https://api.explorer.mezo.org/api`	`https://api.explorer.test.mezo.org/api`
Multicall3	`0xcA11bde05977b3631167028862bE2a173976CA11`	same address, also deployed
Base fee	1,300,000 wei	—
Gas limit	10,000,000	—

Two details in that table cost real time to establish.

BTC has 18 decimals here, not 8. Mezo is an EVM chain and BTC is its gas token, so it follows the EVM convention. Every balance, every gas estimate, and every `msg.value` is a 1e18-scaled quantity. Reusing a Bitcoin-side 1e8 assumption produces errors of ten orders of magnitude, silently, in the direction of thinking the user is rich.

Multicall3 is deployed, at the canonical cross-chain address, on both networks. We confirmed 7,619 bytes of code at that address on 31612 and 31611, and bisected its birth block to exactly **351760** — the address is empty at 351759. This matters because viem's bundled chain definition omits `multicall3` for Mezo mainnet, so every batched read silently degrades to individual calls, or breaks.

3.1

Mezo is not an OP-stack L2

This is the fact that explains most of the ecosystem gaps. Mezo is a **Cosmos SDK + CometBFT chain running an EVM module** — `Mezod/12.0.0`, an Evmos fork embedding go-ethereum `v1.16.9-mezo2`. It is not an Optimism, Arbitrum, or Polygon CDK rollup, and it does not inherit any of the vendor support those stacks get automatically. When a tooling vendor says "we support every EVM chain", they generally mean every chain built on the four stacks they have already integrated.

That architecture also produces a handful of EVM divergences worth knowing before you debug them at 2am:

BEHAVIOUR	ON MEZO
`SELFDESTRUCT`	Disabled
`PREVRANDAO`	Returns 0
Blob transactions (type 3)	Rejected
`requestsHash` in block responses	Omitted, although Prague is active
`debug_traceCall`	Not implemented — absent from the mezod source, not merely unexposed

The last row is the one that decides Maren's entire gasless architecture. Section 8.

3.2

Endpoint selection is an engineering decision

Mezo's RPC landscape is thin enough that choosing an endpoint is a design decision rather than a configuration detail.

Three published hosts do not exist. `rpc.mezo.org` and `testnet-rpc.mezo.org` are listed in Mezo's own documentation and return NXDOMAIN, as does `testnet-explorer.mezo.org`. A pull request correcting these is prepared. Separately, none of Alchemy, QuickNode, Ankr, Infura, or Chainstack support Mezo at all, which leaves a short list of endpoints that work.

The endpoints that do exist are transiently unreliable in a way that is easy to misdiagnose. During development, one endpoint returned `-32601 the method does not exist/is not available` for `eth_call`, `eth_getLogs`, and `eth_estimateGas` across an entire probe sweep, and then served all three correctly an hour later. A degraded backend

behind a load balancer answering `-32601` is indistinguishable, from a single probe, from an endpoint that genuinely lacks the method. On this chain a `-32601` is therefore not evidence of a missing capability, and one probe is not evidence of anything.

That shapes the architecture, not just the configuration. Maren's chain configuration lists several endpoints and every client fails over across them rather than pinning one URL. The relayer additionally runs a boot-time capability preflight and refuses to start if no configured endpoint survives it.

TYPESCRIPT

```typescript
// packages/sdk/src/chains.ts — an endpoint is usable only if it serves the methods an
// application actually needs, and it is re-checked rather than trusted once.
const CERTIFYING_CALLS = ['eth_call', 'eth_getLogs', 'eth_getBlockByNumber'] as const;

// A chain-ID check proves a host is reachable. It does not prove it is serving.
// Clients fail over across endpoints; the relayer preflights and refuses to boot
// when none of them pass.
```

VERIFIED

`TroveManager.getTroveOwnersCount()` → `26`, executed against `https://jsonrpc-mezo.boar.network` on 2026-08-15. This is simultaneously the endpoint certification and the trove count the investment thesis rests on.

There is no public WebSocket endpoint on Mezo that we have been able to verify. Maren's indexing design assumes polling and webhooks, not subscriptions, which is section 9.

3.3

Precompiles and standard infrastructure

COMPONENT	ADDRESS	STATUS
BTC gas-token precompile	`0x7b7C000000000000000000000000000000000000`	Live
Price oracle precompile	`0x7b7c0000000000000000000000000000000000015`	Live, Skip Connect
RIP-7212 `P256VERIFY`	`0x0000000000000000000000000000000000000100`	Active
Multicall3	`0xcA11bde05977b3631167028862bE2a173976CA11`	Deployed, birth block 351760
Permit2	`canonical`	Deployed
CREATE2 deployer	`canonical`	Deployed
ERC-4337 EntryPoint v0.7	`0x0000000071727De22E5E9d8BAf0edAc6f37da032`	Deployed and inert — see section 8
x402 settlement proxy	`0x402085c248EeA27D92E8b30b2C58ed07f9E20001`	Live on both networks

The active `P256VERIFY` precompile is worth one line beyond the table: on-chain passkey and WebAuthn signature verification is native and cheap on Mezo. For a consumer Bitcoin product, biometric authorisation without a browser extension is a real unlock, and it is available here without a bespoke verifier contract.

4

The MUSD integration surface

MUSD is a fork of Threshold USD, itself a fork of Liquity v1. All core contracts are `TransparentUpgradeableProxy`; we always integrate against the proxy.

CONTRACT	MAINNET (31612)
MUSD	`0xdD468A1DDc392dcdbEf6db6e34E89AA338F9F186`
BorrowerOperations	`0x44b1bac67dDA612a41a58AAf779143B181dEe031`
BorrowerOperationsSignatures	`0xB57ab578BF20b3e318f3EFAA587C51DBccE5df7a`
TroveManager	`0x94AfB503dBca74aC3E4929BACEeDfCe19B93c193`
StabilityPool	`0x73245Eff485aB3AAc1158B3c4d8f4b23797B0e32`
PriceFeed	`0xc5aC5A8892230E0A3e1c473881A2de7353fFcA88`
SortedTroves	`0x8C5DB4C62BF29c1C4564390d10c20a47E0b2749f`
HintHelpers	`0xD267b3bE2514375A075fd03C3D9CBa6b95317DC3`
InterestRateManager	`0x4a453700d157717Fe02fB62E7700ED7845048285`
GovernableVariables	`0x560AC4Ea44Fb7EB2D4d3c00608CB1CAb2613d389`

Matsnet equivalents are in `packages/sdk/src/addresses.ts`. All fifteen addresses were verified three independent ways: the `mezo-org/musd` deployment artifacts, the OpenZeppelin proxy manifest (14/14 match), and live `eth_getCode` plus functional calls.

4.1

Call sequences

Collateral is native BTC passed as `msg.value`. There is no ERC-20 approval step for collateral, and — importantly — **no `_maxFeePercentage` parameter anywhere**.

SOLIDITY

```
// Open. msg.value is the BTC collateral; _debtAmount is NET debt, minimum 1,800e18.
// Total debt becomes _debtAmount + 200e18 gas compensation.
function openTrove(uint256 _debtAmount, address _upperHint, address _lowerHint) external
payable;

// Adjust. Either msg.value > 0 or _collWithdrawal > 0 — both positive reverts.
function adjustTrove(
    uint256 _collWithdrawal,
    uint256 _debtChange,
    bool    _isDebtIncrease,
    address _upperHint,
    address _lowerHint
) external payable;

// Narrower forms of the same adjustment, all hint-bearing.
function addColl(address _upperHint, address _lowerHint) external payable;
function withdrawColl(uint256 _amount, address _upperHint, address _lowerHint) external;
function withdrawMUSD(uint256 _amount, address _upperHint, address _lowerHint) external;
function repayMUSD(uint256 _amount, address _upperHint, address _lowerHint) external;

// Close. Requires the caller to hold the full debt less the 200e18 gas compensation.
function closeTrove() external;
```

Every one of those calls needs an insertion hint, because `SortedTroves` maintains the trove list ordered by nominal ICR and inserting without a hint is O(n) in gas.

```typescript
// Hint computation. HintHelpers.getApproxHint does a seeded random walk; SortedTroves
// turns that approximation into the exact neighbours.
const numTroves = await sortedTroves.read.getSize();
const numTrials = Math.ceil(Math.sqrt(Number(numTroves))) * 15;

const [approxHint] = await hintHelpers.read.getApproxHint([
  nominalIcr,
  BigInt(numTrials),
  randomSeed,
]);

const [upperHint, lowerHint] = await sortedTroves.read.findInsertPosition([
  nominalIcr,
  approxHint,
  approxHint,
]);
```

With 26 troves on mainnet, `numTrials` is 75 and the search is effectively free. This is a case where the current smallness of Mezo is an operational advantage: hint computation is a solved cost today, and `MarenVault` holds one trove regardless of how many users sit inside it, so Maren's hint cost does not grow with Maren's user count.

Reads for position health come from `TroveManager.getEntireDebtAndColl`, which returns six values, and from `getTroveMaxBorrowingCapacity`, which is the real borrow limit. Both are covered in the next section, because both are places a ported Liquity frontend breaks.

4.2

Position math, and which way it rounds

The headline number in MRN-DOC-001 — the collateral required to reach the 1,800 MUSD minimum — is not a calculation performed in a document. It is the output of `collateralRequiredFor()` in `packages/sdk/src/position.ts`, executed against the live oracle price of $63,071.83, and asserted by a test that requires the result to fall between 0.078 and 0.080 BTC:

QUANTITY	VALUE
Minimum net debt	1,800 MUSD
Gas compensation	200 MUSD
Minimum total debt	2,000 MUSD
Target collateral ratio	250%
BTC price used	$63,071.83
Collateral required	**0.079346 BTC ($5,004.50)**
Maren pooled floor	0.001 BTC
Reduction	79.3×

The reduction is 79.3×. We write “roughly eighty times” and never round it to 100×, for the same reason the position math itself rounds in one direction only.

Collateral ratios round down. Liquidation prices and collateral requirements round up. A position can therefore never display as safer than it is. `179.99%` renders as `179.9%`, never `180%`, because 180% is the borrow threshold and the flattering rounding would tell a user they can act when they cannot. BRAND.md §8 states the rule; the SDK enforces it at the point where the number is produced rather than at the point where it is displayed, so no client can accidentally round the wrong way.

5

The seven Liquity divergences

MUSD is a Liquity v1 descendant, and that is a trap. It is close enough that a ported frontend compiles and far enough that it fails in production. These seven divergences are recorded in `packages/sdk/src/constants.ts` because they are integration-critical, and each one was found by reading the deployed contracts.

5.1

No `_maxFeePercentage` on any borrower operation

Liquity's `openTrove`, `adjustTrove`, and `withdrawLUSD` all take a slippage guard because Liquity's borrowing fee floats with a decaying base rate. MUSD's rates are flat and timelocked, so the guard is unnecessary — and the parameter is simply gone.

Why it breaks a port: the ABI does not match. A ported frontend encodes an extra argument and every call reverts on decode, with no useful error. This is the first thing that will happen to anyone who pastes a Liquity ABI into a Mezo project.

5.2

`PriceFeed.fetchPrice()` is `view` and reverts on staleness

It reverts if the oracle is more than **60 seconds** stale. There is **no `lastGoodPrice()` getter**; the `LastGoodPriceUpdated` event exists but is vestigial.

Why it breaks a port: Liquity frontends call `lastGoodPrice()` for display and treat the price as always available. On Mezo that function does not exist, and the function that does exist is a revert risk on every borrow, adjust, redeem, and liquidate path. A frontend without an explicit "price unavailable" state will show a blank or a zero and let the user submit a transaction that cannot succeed.

5.3

`maxBorrowingCapacity` is a Mezo-only per-trove ceiling

Each trove carries a borrowing ceiling fixed at the price prevailing when the trove was opened. **Adding collateral does not raise it.** Only `refinance()` does.

Why it breaks a port: every Liquity frontend derives the borrow limit from ICR and current price. On Mezo that number is wrong — usually too high — so the interface offers the user a borrow that will revert. The real limit is `TroveManager.getTroveMaxBorrowingCapacity()`, and it must be displayed as the limit.

5.4

No base rate accumulator and no redemption-fee decay

There is no `baseRate`, no `getRedemptionRateWithDecay()`, and no `REDEMPTION_FEE_FLOOR()`. The redemption rate is a flat, governable 0.75%.

Why it breaks a port: those getters are missing, not merely constant. Any redemption UI that calls them fails at the ABI, and any fee projection that models decay is wrong.

5.5

Recovery Mode does not expand liquidations

In Liquity, Recovery Mode allows liquidation of troves up to the 150% critical ratio. In MUSD, **the liquidation threshold stays 110% in both modes.** Recovery Mode only forces new loans to open at ≥150% and blocks `refinance()`.

Why it breaks a port: this is the most dangerous divergence, because it fails in the direction of alarming users. A ported frontend entering Recovery Mode will tell a user at 130% that they are about to be liquidated when they are not. It also misleads a liquidation bot into attempting liquidations that revert.

5.6

Collateral is native BTC, not an ERC-20

Collateral arrives as `msg.value`. There is no approval step and no collateral token address.

Why it breaks a port: a ported flow shows an "approve collateral" step that cannot be satisfied, and encodes collateral as a call argument rather than as value, so the trove opens with zero collateral or the call reverts.

5.7

Debt is split into principal and interest

`getEntireDebtAndColl` returns **six** values — `coll`, `principal`, `interest`, `pendingCollateral`, `pendingPrincipal`, `pendingInterest` — where Liquity v1 returns four.

Why it breaks a port: tuple destructuring silently misaligns. The value a ported frontend labels "collateral" is a different quantity entirely, and it will render a confident, wrong number on the user's position screen. Interest must be added to principal to get total debt; treating `principal` as the debt understates what the user owes.

> WARNING
>
> Six of these seven produce a revert, which is survivable. Two of them — the Recovery Mode threshold and the six-value debt tuple — produce a *plausible wrong number* on a screen a user makes financial decisions from. Those are the ones that matter, and they are the reason Maren reads the deployed contracts rather than a reference implementation.

6

Three places the docs and the code disagree

Offered to the Mezo team as findings. In each case Maren follows the code, and records the disagreement so nobody later "fixes" our implementation to match a document. The first two are in the `mezo-org/documentation` repository, at `users/borrow/fees.md` lines 13 and 33 and `users/borrow/index.md` line 30.

6.1

The borrower redemption-fee waiver does not exist

Mezo's documentation states that borrowers with an outstanding loan pay a zero redemption fee. The deployed `TroveManager` applies `getRedemptionRate()` unconditionally. `isAccountFeeExempt` is defined on `GovernableVariables` and referenced **only from** `BorrowerOperations` — three call sites, all on the borrowing path. It is never consulted by `TroveManager` on the redemption path.

Consequence: do not promise a borrower redemption-fee waiver in a user interface. A user who acts on that promise loses 0.75% in BTC.

6.2

The refinancing fee is not 0.1%

The docs list the refinance fee as 0.1%. The code sets `refinancingFeePercentage = 20` and computes `amount = (refinancingFeePercentage * oldDebt) / 100` — 20% of old net debt — then applies the 0.1% borrowing fee to *that* amount. The effective cost is approximately **0.02% of old net debt**, an order of magnitude cheaper than documented.

Consequence: the documented number is wrong in the user's favour, which is the less dangerous direction, but a product that quotes 0.1% is overcharging its own users' expectations and under-recommending a useful operation. Since `refinance()` is the only way to raise `maxBorrowingCapacity`, this matters for the borrow-limit UX.

6.3

“100% Bitcoin-backed” is true of the CDP, not of circulating MUSD

Total MUSD supply is approximately **31.08 million**. Trove-backed debt is approximately **1.6 million**, plus an outstanding PCV bootstrap loan of approximately **15.0 million**. The remainder sits in protocol-owned strategies and the Wormhole NTT bridge.

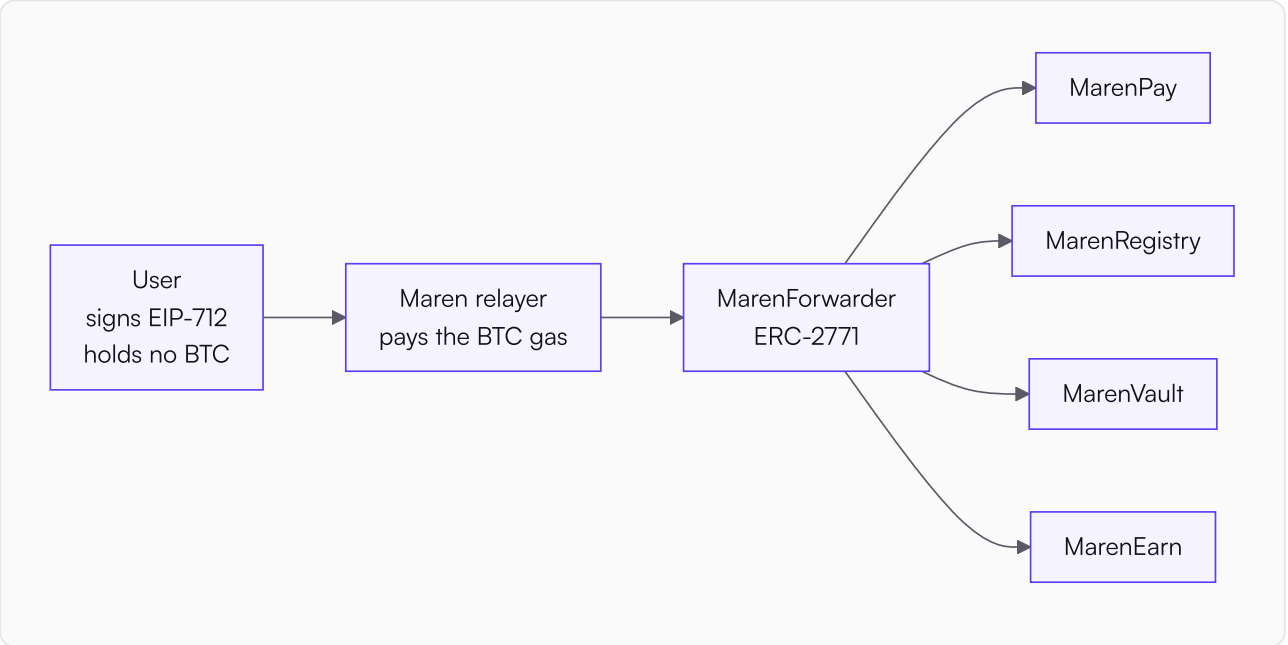
Consequence: the CDP portion is fully Bitcoin-backed and that claim is defensible. A blanket “every MUSD is backed by Bitcoin” statement is not, and Maren does not repeat it to users. This is also the clearest illustration of the thesis’s central number: 31.08 million MUSD and 29,360 holders sit above a CDP with 26 troves in it.

7

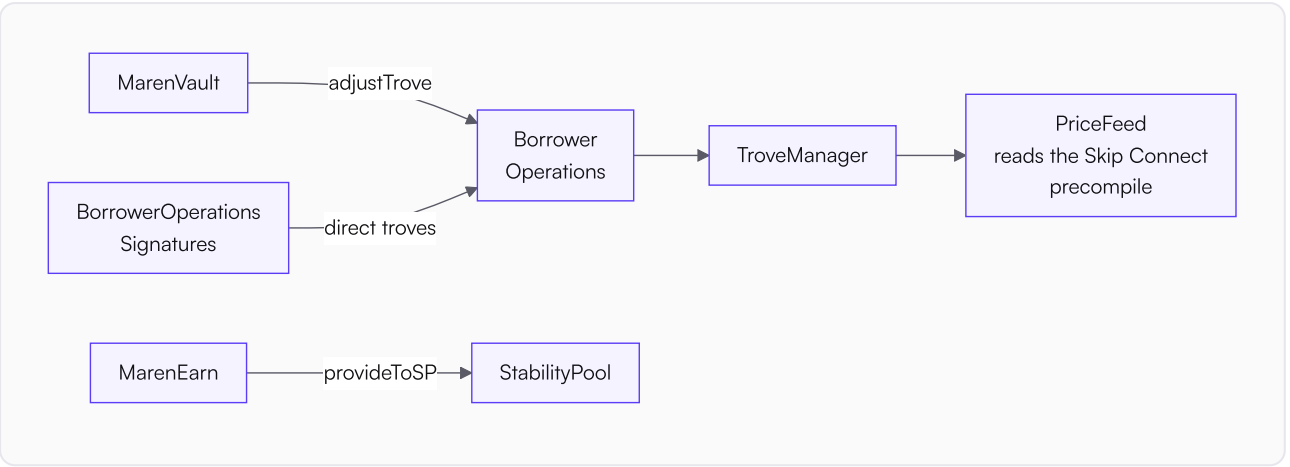
Maren’s contract architecture

Solidity 0.8.28, Foundry, OpenZeppelin v5. Five contracts, in `packages/contracts/src/`.

The system is easiest to read as two paths: how a user action gets in, and where it settles. **Getting in** — the user signs, the relayer pays, the forwarder dispatches:



Settling — Maren’s contracts call Mezo’s, and every price ultimately comes from the same precompile the liquidation engine uses:



7.1

`MarenForwarder` — gasless execution

An ERC-2771 trusted forwarder built on OpenZeppelin's `ERC2771Forwarder`. Users sign an EIP-712 `ForwardRequest`; the relayer submits it and pays the BTC gas. Domain `Maren Forwarder`, version `1`. Replay protection is a per-signer nonce plus a deadline. Only Maren contracts trust it; it is never a general-purpose relayer.

7.2

`MarenRegistry` — handles

`@sele` to address. Commit-reveal registration to stop front-running, 3—32 characters from `[a-z0-9_]`, one primary handle per address, reverse resolution for display.

7.3

`MarenPay` — payments

`ERC2771Context`, operating on MUSD. `pay(to, amount, memo)` with an on-chain memo event; `payTo(handle, amount, memo)` resolving through the registry; `createRequest` / `fulfillRequest`; `createLink` / `claimLink` for claimable links, where the claimer needs no prior relationship and no BTC; and `split(recipients[], amounts[], memo)` for one signature to many recipients. No custody — MUSD moves wallet to wallet via `transferFrom` under the user's own permit.

7.4

`MarenVault` — pooled Bitcoin credit

The differentiator, and the risk. One large, conservatively managed trove; users hold a proportional claim with a per-user ledger.

PROPERTY	VALUE
Minimum deposit	`0.001 BTC`
Protocol MCR	`110%`
Maren internal liquidation CR	`140%`
Maren target CR	`250%`
Maren minimum healthy CR	`180%`
Internal liquidation penalty	`5%`

A keeper tops up collateral, repays debt, and internally liquidates unhealthy users by seizing collateral at a 5% penalty and repaying their share of pooled debt. Users can always exit by repaying their debt share and withdrawing collateral. If the pooled trove would breach policy, **borrowing halts before withdrawal does** — exits stay open when entries close.

7.5

`MarenEarn` — yield

An ERC-4626 vault over the MUSD Stability Pool. It sweeps the BTC liquidation gains the Stability Pool pays out, converts them, and compounds them back into MUSD so `totalAssets()` grows for shareholders.

> WARNING
>
> The MUSD Stability Pool has **no token emissions**. Yield is liquidation gains only, which makes it lumpy and not an APY anyone may advertise as fixed. Maren displays trailing realised yield, labelled as backward-looking. Any product presenting a forward APY here is presenting a number it invented.

8

The gasless design

This section exists because the obvious answer is wrong, and being able to say why is worth more than the answer itself.

8.1

ERC-4337 is a dead end on Mezo

EntryPoint v0.7 **is** deployed at `0x0000000071727De22E5E9d8BAf0edAc6f37da032` — 32,073 bytes, byte-identical to the Ethereum L1 deployment. Everything downstream of it is absent:

CHECK	RESULT
UserOperations ever processed	Zero
Contract verified on the explorer	No
Blockscout account-abstraction indexer	`501 Service is disabled`
`debug_traceCall` on Mezo RPCs	Not implemented
Pimlico, Biconomy, ZeroDev, Alchemy, Candide, Coinbase Paymaster, Gelato	Not listed
OpenZeppelin Defender hosted relaying	Retired 2026-07-01

The root cause is one row of that table. Every ERC-7562-compliant bundler validates a UserOperation by tracing it to enforce the opcode and storage-access rules, and that requires `debug_traceCall`. Mezo's RPCs do not implement it — it is absent from the mezod source, not merely unexposed. **No compliant bundler can run against Mezo**, which is why no vendor lists it and why an EntryPoint with 32KB of correct bytecode has processed nothing.

A team that picked ERC-4337 from a diagram would spend weeks discovering this. It is a deployed contract, on the canonical address, with the right bytecode, and it does not work.

8.2

What we do instead

Three live paths, in the order Maren uses them.

1. EIP-2612 permit plus our own ERC-2771 relayer. This is Maren's primary mechanism, and it is exactly what Mezo itself runs in production for its "Get Gas" feature. No bundler, no vendor, no EntryPoint. MUSD supports EIP-2612 `permit`, so a first-time user can approve and transact in one signed action holding zero BTC. Implementation cost is 1—2 weeks, and every component is code we control and can audit.

2. Interoperate with x402. Mezo operates its own gasless payment rail: the x402 settlement proxy at `0x402085c248EeA27D92E8b30b2C58ed07f9E20001` — 5,829 bytes, the

same address on both networks — with a facilitator at `https://facilitator.vativ.io` and the `@x402/evm` SDK at version 2.15.0 or later. Because MUSD supports both permit2 and EIP-2612, a buyer authorises a payment with a single EIP-712 signature: no approval transaction, no gas. Maren interoperates with this rather than competing with it. A payment rail that the chain operates and that Maren's users can settle against is an asset, not a rival.

3. EIP-7702, as the upgrade path. EIP-7702 is **live on Mezo mainnet from block 9,275,000**, with both Prague and Osaka active. mezod ships a dedicated specification whose stated intent is that sponsored-transaction flows work "without external relayers". That is the path to transaction batching and session keys, and combined with the active `P256VERIFY` precompile it is also the path to passkey-authorised accounts. Maren does not depend on it for launch; it is the direction of travel once the simpler mechanism is live and audited.

8.3

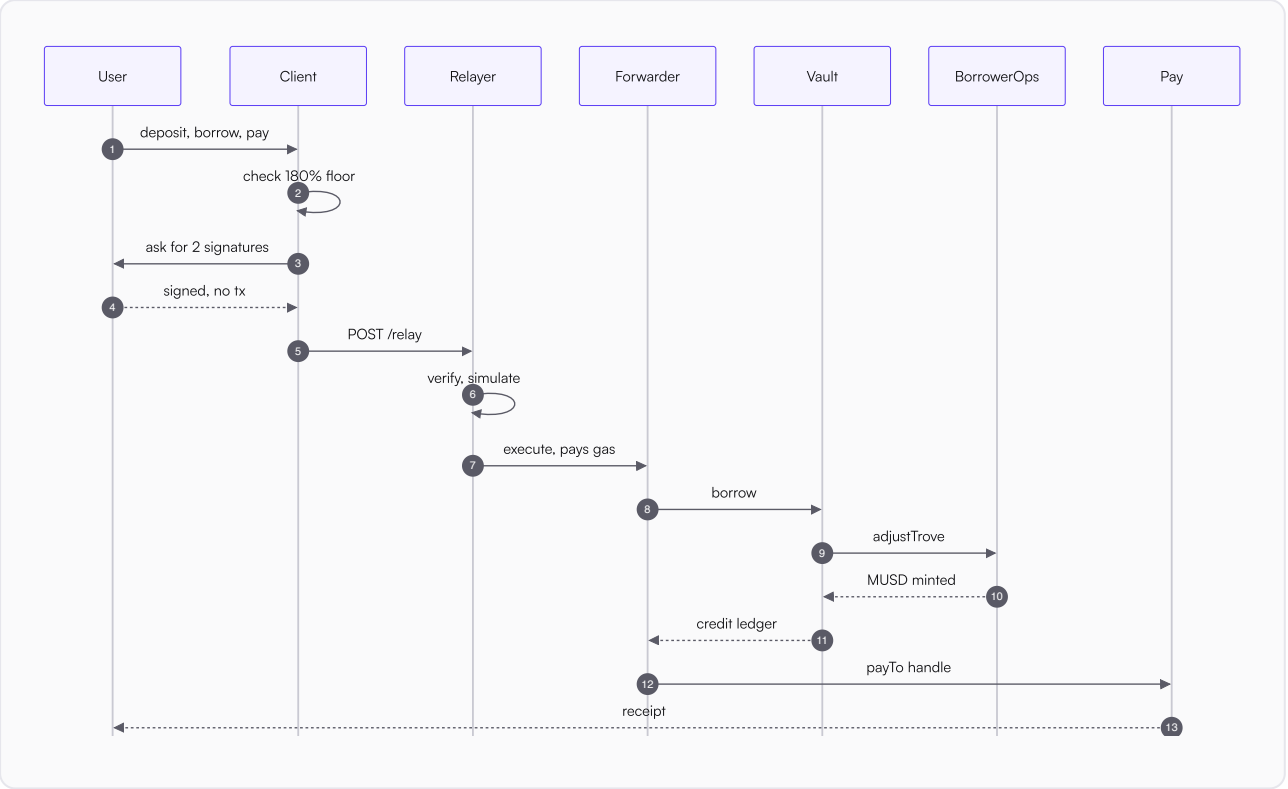
Why we call Mezo's signature contract rather than wrap it

Mezo ships `BorrowerOperationsSignatures`, an EIP-712 signed variant of every borrower operation. For **direct** troves, Maren calls Mezo's contract directly rather than routing through `MarenForwarder`.

The reasoning is trust surface, not convenience. Wrapping it would mean a user's direct-trove position depends on Maren's forwarder being correct. Calling it means the position depends only on Mezo's already-deployed, already-reviewed contract, and Maren's forwarder covers only Maren-native actions — Pay, Earn, Registry, and the pooled Vault. A user with a direct trove can walk away from Maren entirely and their position is untouched. That property is worth more than code reuse.

8.4

A gasless borrow-and-pay, end to end



Reading the numbered steps against the prose: the client checks Maren's own 180% policy floor before it asks for anything (2); the user produces an EIP-712 `ForwardRequest` and an EIP-2612 `permit` and no transaction at all (3—4); the relayer verifies the signature against its allowlist and budget and simulates by `eth_call` before spending gas (6); the forwarder resolves the true sender so `MarenVault` credits the right ledger (8, 11); and the user ends holding MUSD and a receipt without ever having held BTC (13).

The relayer's guarantees are narrow and worth stating precisely. It will only relay to Maren contracts, only for known selectors. It rate-limits per address and per IP, and carries a per-address daily sponsorship budget. Its policy is that the first 25 actions per address are free, after which a small fee is taken in MUSD **inside the same transaction**, so a new user is never blocked at the door. It manages nonces under a per-key mutex and bumps replacement fees on stuck transactions. It never holds user funds: compromise of the relayer key costs Maren its gas float, not a user's money.

9

Off-chain

9.1

Indexing

Mezo has **no public subgraph** — `mezo-org/subgraphs` returns 404 — and is not in The Graph's registry. Envio HyperSync and Alchemy webhooks do not cover it either.

Goldsky is the only indexer Mezo endorses, with network slugs `mezo` and `mezo-testnet`, and it is what Maren uses. Blockscout REST v2 at `https://api.explorer.mezo.org/api/v2` covers ad-hoc reads and backfill verification — note the `api.` subdomain, because `explorer.mezo.org/api/...` returns 404.

This is a genuine single point of dependency and we treat it as one. Every Maren contract emits events sufficient to rebuild all application state from chain history alone, so a Goldsky outage degrades Maren to slower reads via Multicall3 and Blockscout rather than breaking it. No user-visible balance is ever sourced only from the index; positions and balances are read from chain state, and the index serves history, search, and notifications.

9.2

Price handling

`PriceFeed.fetchPrice()` reads the Skip Connect oracle — Mezo's own consensus-level `x/oracle` Cosmos module, exposed as the precompile at `0x7b7c000000000000000000000000000000000015`. It is Chainlink-`AggregatorV3`-shaped and implements only `decimals()` and `latestRoundData()`; `description()` reverts. It returns 18 decimals, and on 2026-08-15 it returned BTC at **$63,071.83**, updated seconds earlier.

It is **not Chainlink and not Pyth.** It is secured by Mezo's validator set. That is a different trust model from an independent third-party oracle network, and it belongs in the risk section of any honest document.

RISK

Pyth **is** deployed on Mezo, at `0x2880aB155794e7179c9eE2e38200202908C17B43`, and it is not a usable substitute: its feeds are approximately **28 days stale** and ETH/USD reverts outright. A developer who reaches for the familiar oracle because it is present will build liquidation math on a month-old price. Maren uses the precompile, the same source MUSD's own liquidation engine uses, because using a different price from the protocol that liquidates you is its own category of bug.

The 60-second staleness revert propagates into every borrow, adjust, redeem, and liquidate path. Maren's handling: both clients have an explicit "price feed unavailable" state; we never render a stale price as live; the keeper treats a price revert as a hold rather than an error and retries with backoff; and the pooled vault's 140% internal ratio exists partly to absorb the window in which no liquidation can execute because nobody can read a price.

9.3

Failure modes

FAILURE	DETECTION	RESPONSE
Oracle stale beyond 60s	`fetchPrice()` reverts	Clients show "price unavailable"; borrowing disabled; keeper holds and retries
Certified RPC degrades	Certification probe fails on `eth_call`	Fail over to the second certified endpoint
Goldsky lag or outage	Indexed head trails chain head	History degrades; balances and positions still read from chain via Multicall3
Relayer key compromised	Budget anomaly, unexpected selector	Revoke the forwarder's relayer allowlist entry; user funds unaffected
Relayer out of BTC	Balance floor alarm	Sponsorship pauses; users may still self-submit with their own BTC
Pooled trove approaches 140%	Per-block keeper check	Halt new borrowing, top up collateral, then internally liquidate
MUSD proxy upgraded	Implementation address changes	Integration paused pending review; we monitor the proxy admin

10

Delivery plan

STAGE	NETWORK	GATE
1. Build and integrate	matsnet, 31611	All five contracts deployed, a pooled trove seeded, the full borrow-pay-earn-exit loop run end to end
2. Audit	—	Third-party audit of `MarenVault` and `MarenForwarder` — the two contracts that carry risk — with findings and remediations published
3. Capped mainnet	mainnet, 31612	Vault deployed with a hard cap; the cap is raised only as the position proves out

Mezo Market listing requires MUSD integration, a third-party audit submitted to the Supernormal Foundation, and a live mainnet deployment. Deployment itself is permissionless, so nothing in this plan waits on a Mezo approval.

The proxy admin for Maren's own upgradeable components sits behind a timelock and a multisig from deployment day one, not as a later hardening step.

11

What could go wrong, and what we would do

The pooled trove takes a loss. The design risk. A BTC drawdown faster than the keeper can act socialises losses across pooled depositors, because collateral is segregated in accounting rather than in custody. Mitigations are the 140%-versus-110% buffer, per-block keeper checks, halting borrowing before withdrawals, and an insurance buffer funded from vault fees. If it happens anyway, the response is disclosed loss allocation by the published per-user ledger, the vault paused for entries, exits kept open, and a public post-mortem. Users above the protocol minimum are steered to direct troves specifically so the population exposed to this is the population that has no alternative.

The relayer key is compromised. The blast radius is Maren's gas float, by design. The forwarder's allowlist is revocable, so the response is revocation, rotation, and refill. No user signature becomes usable to an attacker, because every action is bound to the user's own EIP-712 signature and MUSD moves under the user's own permit.

MUSD is upgraded underneath us. Every core MUSD contract is a transparent proxy controlled by Mezo's multisig. We monitor implementation addresses and pause integration on change pending review. We cannot mitigate this further, and we would rather write that down than imply otherwise.

The oracle stops. Borrowing and liquidation both stop, for Maren and for the protocol alike. Maren's exposure is that the pooled vault cannot be defended during the window. The 140% internal ratio is sized to survive a plausible outage rather than a worst case, and we will publish the assumption rather than let it be inferred.

Goldsky becomes unavailable. Degraded history and search, functioning core product, per the indexing section. Every contract emits enough to rebuild state from chain history, so the recovery path is a reindex, not a data loss.

Mezo's tooling gaps get worse before better. The realistic version of this risk is that we continue to carry chain-integration work that a mature ecosystem would give us for free. Our answer is to keep publishing what we find — the corrected viem chain definition, the endpoint certification rule, the divergence list, and the three doc/code discrepancies in section 6 — so the next team pays less than we did.

We are wrong about demand. The falsifiable version of the thesis is milestone M2 in MRN-DOC-001: 100 distinct addresses holding a pooled position below the 1,800 MUSD protocol minimum. If sub-minimum borrowing demand does not exist on Mezo, that number will not move, and it will not move early. It is deliberately the milestone that is hardest to fake and quickest to disprove.

Every chain fact, address, and protocol parameter in this document was read live from Mezo RPCs on 2026-08-15 using `cast`, and cross-checked against the `mezo-org/musd` deployment artifacts and the OpenZeppelin proxy manifest. The machine-readable versions live in `packages/sdk/src/chains.ts`, `packages/sdk/src/addresses.ts`, and `packages/sdk/src/constants.ts`.

Where Mezo's published documentation contradicts the deployed bytecode, this document follows the bytecode and records the disagreement. Those disagreements are offered to the Mezo team as findings, not as criticism.